Business Architecture

Local stores. Local deals. Local customers. | Bengaluru-first

A neighbourhood marketplace where local shops, showrooms, hotels, service providers and event organisers list their products and deals in one place, so customers in that area discover them and order directly. Mintadeal also sells its own sourced catalogue through the same experience.

THE MODEL	HOW IT WORKS
Vendors	Local shops and businesses list products and offers; they choose delivery, pickup or venue offers
Customers	**Nearby** for local orders; **Deals in Bangalore** for city-wide delivery and venue offers
Fulfilment	Shop delivery, Mintadeal-booked partner delivery, pickup, or QR offer used at the venue
Mintadeal	Commission and own catalogue first; paid boosts and onboarding fees added later

Version 2 replaces the earlier generic blueprint with the agreed local-deals model. Commercial terms, service levels and regulatory obligations still require validation before launch.

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A working map of the business, the three journeys, and what the first version must do.

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Design principle: one marketplace, one seller model. Mintadeal's own catalogue is listed as an internal vendor under the same rules as every other shop. It does not get a separate storefront or order system.

01 Executive summary: the core idea

Every neighbourhood has grocery stores, meat shops, clothing stores, electronics showrooms, hardware shops, restaurants, hotels and service providers. Most of them already try to win customers online by posting on Instagram, WhatsApp and Facebook. That effort is mostly lost: a shop's post only reaches the people who already follow that shop.

Mintadeal puts every shop in the area in front of everyone in the area. A customer who opens the app for the meat shop also sees the clothing store's offer and the hardware shop's new stock. Customers get to know the shops around them, and shops reach people they could never reach on their own. Customers order directly on Mintadeal; shops deliver, offer pickup, or welcome the customer at their venue.

Value proposition

FOR	VALUE
Customers	Discover nearby shops and their deals in one place; order for delivery or pickup, or buy offers used at the venue; see price, delivery fee and timing before paying.
Local vendors	A storefront and an audience that is the whole neighbourhood, not just their own followers. Post a product or deal as easily as an Instagram post and receive real orders. Pay mainly when they get orders.
Mintadeal	Commission on orders, margin on its own catalogue, and later paid boosts and onboarding fees.

The reach effect

Each shop that joins brings its own followers and WhatsApp customers to Mintadeal by sharing its store link. Those customers then see every other shop in the area. The more shops join an area, the more each shop gains, which is the network effect Mintadeal is built on.

Local stores, local deals, local customers. The goal is not millions of users; it is being the place a neighbourhood checks first, area by area.

02 Business actors and operating model

ACTOR	RESPONSIBILITY
Customer	Browses Nearby and Deals in Bangalore, follows shops, orders, pays, tracks, shows QR at venues, rates shops, raises issues.
Vendor (external)	Local shop or business: grocery, meat, clothing, electronics, showroom, hardware, hotel, restaurant, service provider, event organiser. Manages its storefront, listings, stock, prices, fulfilment choice and order acceptance.
Mintadeal internal vendor	Mintadeal's own catalogue, sourced from suppliers when a good deal is available. Uses the same listing, order and policy rules as external vendors.
Mintadeal operations	Vendor onboarding and verification, listing quality, order exceptions, delivery partner bookings, customer and vendor support.
Finance	Commission, delivery cost recovery, vendor payouts, invoices, reconciliation, tax workflows.
Delivery partner	Third-party courier booked by Mintadeal when a shop requests it; receives only the details needed for the job.
Payment provider	Collects customer payments and splits settlement so each shop's share goes to the shop and Mintadeal keeps its fees.

How the parts connect

Vendor posts products & deals → **Mintadeal** shows them to the area → **Customer** orders & pays → **Fulfilment** delivery / pickup / QR → **Settlement** payout minus fees

Ownership boundary

Mintadeal owns the platform, listing rules, checkout, payment setup, delivery partner bookings and marketplace support. The vendor owns its stock, prices, product quality, preparation, its own deliveries and honouring venue offers. These responsibilities are written into the vendor agreement and shown clearly to customers.

03 Vendor journey

Sign up phone & business details → **Verify** ID, bank, GST if any → **Set up** storefront & area → **List** products & offers → **Fulfil** deliver / pickup / QR → **Get paid** payout & reports

Who can be a vendor: grocery stores, meat and fish shops, bakeries, clothing stores, electronics and furniture showrooms, hardware shops, restaurants and hotels, salons, gyms and other service providers, event organisers, and other local businesses.

What a vendor can do

CAPABILITY	DETAIL
List individual products	Photo, name, price, offer price, stock or available/unavailable, variants (size, colour, weight).
List offers (no physical delivery)	Hotel stays, restaurant deals, salon or gym services, event tickets. The customer buys online and receives a QR code to use at the venue.
Deliver themselves	Shop sets its delivery radius or pin codes, delivery fee, minimum order and time window.
Request a delivery partner	Shop asks Mintadeal to book a partner per order; cost is shown to the shop first and recovered from it (section 08).
Offer pickup only	Customer orders and collects from the shop; the shop marks the order as collected.
Deliver across Bangalore	Shop opts in to city-wide delivery; its listings then also appear in Deals in Bangalore.

Onboarding steps

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
Application	Shop name, owner, phone, address and map pin, category, payout bank or UPI account, GST number if registered.
Review	Mintadeal checks identity and bank details and approves, rejects or asks for more information.
Setup	Storefront photos, opening hours, fulfilment options, delivery area and fees. Mintadeal staff can do this for the shop in early areas.
Agreement	Vendor accepts commission terms, payout schedule, cancellation and refund rules, and responsibilities.
Go live	First listings checked, a test order completed, and the shop receives its store link and counter QR poster to share.

Making it easy for shopkeepers

- Posting a product or deal takes under a minute from a phone: photo, price, offer, post.
- New orders arrive on WhatsApp/SMS as well as in the app, with one-tap accept or reject, plus a simple daily summary of orders and payouts.
- Customers can **follow** a shop, so its new deals reach its followers automatically, like Instagram.

04 Listings and fulfilment modes

A listing describes **what** the customer buys. The fulfilment mode describes **how** it reaches them. The vendor picks the fulfilment modes for each listing, and the platform checks that the choice fits the listing and the customer's location.

Listing types

TYPE	EXAMPLES	KEY FIELDS
Product	Groceries, meat, clothes, electronics, hardware, Mintadeal's own catalogue	Price, offer price, stock, variants, photos, tax category, allowed fulfilment modes
Offer (no physical delivery)	Hotel stay, restaurant meal deal, salon service, gym pass, event ticket	Price, what's included, validity dates or time slots, capacity, number of people, terms, cancellation rule

Fulfilment modes

MODE	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE	HOW IT WORKS
Shop delivery	Vendor	Vendor delivers within its declared area and time window and marks the order delivered. Delivery fee set by the vendor.
Partner delivery	Mintadeal books; vendor pays	Vendor requests a partner when the order is ready. Mintadeal books and pays the partner and recovers the cost from the vendor.
Pickup	Vendor	Customer collects from the shop. The shop confirms collection with the order number or QR.
QR at venue	Vendor	Customer shows the order QR at the hotel, restaurant, salon or event. The vendor scans it and it is marked used.

Every order line records its fulfilment mode and who is responsible for it. A cart with items from several shops becomes one parent order with a separate sub-order per shop, each with its own fee, timing and status.

Where listings appear

LISTING	NEARBY	DEALS IN BANGALORE
Product, shop delivery or partner delivery within area	Yes, if the customer's address is inside the delivery area	No
Product, pickup only	Yes, sorted by distance	No
Product, shop delivers across all of Bangalore	Yes	Yes
Offer used at venue (QR)	Yes, sorted by distance	Yes
Mintadeal own catalogue	Yes, where deliverable	Yes, if shipped city-wide

05 QR offers at the venue

Offers that need no physical delivery, such as hotels, restaurants, services and events, are bought on Mintadeal and used in person. After payment, the customer gets a QR code in their order. The vendor scans it at the venue to confirm the purchase.

Buy offer pay online → **Get QR** in order & on WhatsApp → **Visit venue** within validity → **Vendor scans** vendor app → **Marked used** cannot be reused

QR rules

RULE	DETAIL
Single use	Once scanned, the QR is marked used and any later scan shows "already used" with the time and place it was used.
Right vendor only	Only the logged-in vendor (or its staff) that sold the offer can redeem it. Any other vendor sees "not valid here".
Valid dates only	The QR works only within the offer's validity dates or booked time slot. Outside them it shows "not yet valid" or "expired".
Groups	An offer for several people either uses one QR covering all of them or one QR per person, chosen when the offer is created.
Secure code	The QR holds a random, unguessable reference checked against Mintadeal's server, not the order details themselves.
Fallback	If the camera or connection fails, the vendor types the order number and the customer's last 4 phone digits.
Unused and expired	The refund or credit rule for unused offers is set per offer and shown to the customer before payment.
Settlement	For venue offers, the vendor's payout can be released after the QR is redeemed, which protects customers from no-shows by the vendor.

The QR is the order receipt, not a separate coupon. Customers always order and pay through Mintadeal; the QR simply proves the purchase at the venue.

06 Customer journey

Set location home / current → **Discover** Nearby or Bangalore → **Choose** product or offer → **Checkout** delivery / pickup / QR → **Pay** UPI or on delivery → **Receive** track / collect / scan

Two ways to discover

SECTION	WHAT IT SHOWS	HOW IT'S SORTED
Nearby deals	Shops and deals around the customer's location: grocery, meat, clothing, electronics, showrooms, hardware, restaurants, services. Only items that can actually be delivered to, or picked up by, this customer.	Distance, freshness of the deal, shops the customer follows, ratings. Browse by category.
Deals in Bangalore	Only listings from shops that deliver across all of Bangalore, plus offers used at a venue (hotels, events, services, restaurants).	Category, area, price, date (for events). Delivery fee and expected time shown on the listing.

Customer features

- Location and saved addresses; search by shop, item or category.
- Shop storefronts with photos, opening hours, delivery area, fees, policies and ratings.
- **Follow shops** to get their new deals; notifications only with consent.
- Cart and checkout across shops, with each shop's fee and timing shown separately.
- My orders: status timeline, delivery updates, pickup details, offer QR codes.
- Ratings and reviews after each order; help for cancellations, returns and refunds.

Honest discovery

Never show an item as available to a customer who cannot receive it. Hide expired offers and out-of-stock items. Show the original price only when it is genuine. Label paid boosts as "Featured" once they are introduced. Show the full price including delivery fee before payment.

07 Order lifecycle and operating rules

Placed price snapshot → **Paid** or pay on delivery → **Accepted** by shop → **Preparing** packing / booking → **Fulfilled** delivered / collected / scanned → **Settled** payout

STAGE	RULE
Placed	Price, offer, fees, tax and shop terms are saved with the order so later edits by the shop do not change it.
Payment	Prepaid orders are confirmed only after the payment provider confirms payment. Pay-on-delivery orders are flagged as such.
Shop acceptance	Shop is alerted by app and WhatsApp/SMS. If it does not accept within the time limit (for example 15 minutes, set per category), the order is auto-cancelled, the customer is told, and any payment is refunded.
Rejection	Shop can reject only with a reason: out of stock, price changed, outside delivery area, closed. Repeated rejections lower the shop's ranking.
Preparing	Shop packs the order or prepares the booking. For partner delivery, the shop taps "request delivery" when ready.
Out for delivery	Shop or partner updates status; customer sees a timeline. Live tracking shown only when the partner provides it.
Fulfilled	Delivered, collected or QR scanned, with time and who confirmed it.
Cancelled / returned / refunded	Follows the listing's policy; reason, approvals and refund reference are recorded.
Settled	Order amount minus commission, delivery cost (if partner) and refunds is paid to the shop on the payout schedule.

Shop performance rules

- Track each shop's acceptance rate, response time, cancellations and ratings.
- Slow or unreliable shops move down in listings; repeated problems pause the shop until reviewed.
- Every order keeps a complete history of what happened, who did it and when, for support and disputes.

08 Delivery partner model and cost recovery

A shop can deliver orders itself, or ask Mintadeal to send a delivery partner. When Mintadeal books the partner, Mintadeal pays the partner directly and recovers the cost from the shop.

Order ready shop taps request → **See cost** shop confirms → **Mintadeal books** partner assigned → **Delivered** status & proof → **Recover cost** from shop

How the cost is recovered

CUSTOMER PAID	HOW MINTADEAL RECOVERS THE DELIVERY COST
Prepaid (UPI / card)	Deducted automatically from the shop's payout for that order. No collection risk.
Pay on delivery	Mintadeal has paid the partner but holds no money for the order. Recover it by deducting from the shop's next prepaid payouts, a monthly invoice, or a small prepaid delivery balance that shops using this service keep topped up.

Rules

- Show the shop the delivery cost **before** it confirms the request, so there are no disputes later.
- The shop decides how much of the delivery cost to charge the customer as a delivery fee; this is shown at checkout.
- Optional: Mintadeal adds a small booking fee on top of the partner price, as an extra income source.
- If a partner damages or loses an item, Mintadeal claims from the partner and handles the customer's remedy. This is written into the vendor agreement.
- Start with one delivery partner for the first area; add others only when needed.

Pay-on-delivery plus partner delivery is where unpaid amounts build up. Set a limit on how much a shop can owe before partner delivery is paused for that shop.

09 Revenue model and phasing

Mintadeal has four income sources. They are switched on in stages, so small shops are not asked to pay several fees before they have seen any orders.

STAGE	REVENUE	HOW IT WORKS
1. From launch	Commission on orders	A percentage of each order, deducted from the payout (prepaid) or billed (pay on delivery). Shops pay only when they receive orders.
1. From launch	Own catalogue margin	Mintadeal buys products from suppliers when it finds a good deal and sells them as an internal vendor. Margin after purchase, delivery, returns and payment costs.
2. When the area has enough customers	Listing charges (paid boosts)	Basic listings stay free. Shops pay for visibility: featured deal, top of Nearby, homepage spot. Always labelled "Featured".
3. Later	Onboarding fee	Waived for the first shops in each area. Later charged for new shops, or as a premium setup service (photos, catalogue entry done by Mintadeal).
Optional	Delivery booking fee	A small fee on top of the partner's price when Mintadeal books a delivery (section 08).

Own catalogue guardrails

- Prefer products local shops in that area do not sell, or label them clearly as "Mintadeal deals".
- Do not undercut the shops on the platform in their own category; it damages their trust in Mintadeal.
- Same rules as any vendor: same ranking, same policies, seller identity shown to the customer.
- Limit bulk purchases at first; track stock age and sell-through before buying more.
- If Mintadeal ever takes foreign investment, India's rules restrict marketplaces that also hold their own stock. Get legal advice before raising.

Unit economics to measure

For each order: commission + delivery fee recovery − payment charges − support cost. For own catalogue: sale price − purchase cost − delivery − returns − payment charges. Compare against the cost of winning a customer and a shop in each area.

10 Payments and settlement

PAYMENT	HOW IT WORKS
Prepaid (UPI, cards, wallets)	Collected through a payment provider that supports marketplace split settlement. Each shop's share goes to the shop's account and Mintadeal's commission and delivery cost are kept back. Mintadeal does not hold customer funds itself.
Pay on delivery / at pickup	Customer pays the shop directly (cash or the shop's UPI). Mintadeal's commission and any delivery cost are billed to the shop or deducted from its next prepaid payouts.
Venue offers (QR)	Always prepaid. The shop's payout can be released after redemption or on a fixed schedule, as stated in the agreement.

Settlement rules

- An order counts as paid only after the payment provider confirms it, never from the app screen alone.
- Payouts on a fixed schedule (for example weekly), with a statement per shop: orders, commission, delivery costs, refunds, net payout.
- Mintadeal keeps its own complete ledger of every amount in and out, reconciled daily with the payment provider.
- Refunds after payout are recovered from the shop's next payout.
- Changes to payout bank details need verification and are logged.

Using split settlement keeps Mintadeal from holding customers' money, which greatly reduces regulatory and accounting complexity. Confirm the provider's marketplace terms before choosing it.

11 MVP scope

The first version should do the core loop well in one area: shops post, customers discover and order, shops fulfil, everyone is paid correctly.

IN THE MVP	LATER
Vendor sign-up, verification and storefront	Vendor self-service analytics dashboards
Product and offer listings with photos, prices, stock	Bulk catalogue upload, barcode scanning
Nearby deals and Deals in Bangalore	Personalised recommendations
Follow shops; basic search and categories	Advanced search with typo tolerance
Cart, checkout, prepaid UPI and pay on delivery	Wallets, loyalty points, subscriptions
Shop delivery, pickup, QR offers at venue	Multiple delivery partners, live map tracking
Partner delivery booking (one partner)	Automatic partner selection by price/speed
Order alerts on WhatsApp/SMS, accept/reject, timeouts	Chat between customer and shop
Commission, payouts, statements, own catalogue	Paid boosts, onboarding fees
Ratings and reviews; basic support tickets	Native mobile apps (start with a mobile-friendly web app)
Admin console for vendors, listings, orders, payouts	Automated fraud and risk scoring

12 Admin, support and technology

Admin console

AREA	MINIMUM CAPABILITY
Vendors	Application queue, verification, approve/reject/suspend, fulfilment settings, commission terms, delivery balance and dues.
Listings	Review new listings, remove prohibited or misleading items, check offer prices, expire stale deals.
Orders	Search all orders, see full history, handle unaccepted orders, failed deliveries, QR disputes, cancellations and refunds.
Delivery	Partner bookings, costs, failures, claims, recovery from shops.
Finance	Ledger, payout batches, statements, invoices, reconciliation with the payment provider.
Support	Tickets linked to orders and shops, with priority and response targets.

Controls: separate approval for payout changes and large refunds; reason required for manual overrides; every admin action logged with who, what and when.

Technology

LAYER	APPROACH
Apps	Mobile-friendly web app for customers; simple vendor app (web or Android) focused on posting, orders and QR scanning; web admin console.
Backend	One well-structured application with clear modules: vendors, listings, search/location, cart and orders, payments and ledger, delivery, QR, support. No microservices at this stage.
Integrations	Payment provider with split settlement; one delivery partner; WhatsApp/SMS messaging; maps for location and distance.
Data	Relational database for orders and money; location-aware queries for Nearby; image storage for listings; daily backups.
Security	Role-based access (customer, vendor owner and staff, support, finance, admin); vendors see only their own shop; MFA for admins; no card data stored by Mintadeal; QR codes use random server-checked references.

13 India compliance checklist

This is a planning checklist, not legal or tax advice. Confirm each item with a chartered accountant and a lawyer before taking paid orders.

AREA	WHAT TO CHECK
GST for Mintadeal	GST registration; tax on commission, listing charges, delivery booking fees and own-catalogue sales; invoicing to shops.
GST as a marketplace	Obligations as an e-commerce operator, such as collecting tax at source on payouts to sellers and filing related returns.
Seller GST status	Many small shops are not GST-registered. Confirm which unregistered sellers may sell goods through a marketplace and on what conditions.
Consumer protection	E-commerce rules on seller details, price display, returns and refunds, grievance officer and complaint handling.
Data protection	Privacy notice, consent for marketing messages, data retention and deletion, and breach response under India's data protection law.
Payments	Use a licensed payment provider with marketplace split settlement so Mintadeal does not hold customer funds.
Category rules	Food and meat sellers need valid FSSAI licences; some electronics and packaged goods have labelling rules; events may need venue permissions.
Own catalogue	Rules on inventory-holding marketplaces if foreign investment is ever taken; product liability for items Mintadeal sells.
Agreements	Customer terms, vendor agreement (commission, payouts, delivery cost recovery, QR offers, responsibilities), privacy policy, refund policy.

14 First-area launch plan and KPIs

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MOVE ON WHEN
0. Prepare	Choose one dense area (apartment cluster plus its high street). Finalise agreements, payment provider, delivery partner, compliance review.	Agreements signed off; payments and payouts tested end to end.
1. Sign up shops	Visit shops in person. Target a meaningful mix across categories, with enough shops that the area feels full on day one. Mintadeal staff help set up storefronts and first deals. No fees.	Enough active shops with fresh deals across categories.
2. Launch to the area	Each shop shares its store link with its followers and WhatsApp customers; counter QR posters; apartment WhatsApp groups and notice boards.	Customers ordering repeatedly; shops accepting quickly.
3. Prove and fix	Watch acceptance times, cancellations and delivery problems; reconcile every payout; interview shops and customers.	Shops say Mintadeal brings real orders; customers return weekly.
4. Next area	Copy the playbook to the next neighbourhood. Introduce paid boosts in the first area.	Playbook works in a second area at similar cost.

Key measures

AREA	MEASURE
Shops	Active shops per area, new deals posted per shop per week, acceptance rate, response time, shops still active after 3 months.
Customers	Customers per area, weekly active customers, repeat order rate, shops followed per customer, orders from more than one shop.
Orders	Orders per shop per week, average order value, cancellations, failed deliveries, QR offers redeemed.
Money	Commission revenue, own-catalogue margin, delivery costs recovered vs paid, payment charges, cost to win a shop and a customer.
Trust	Ratings, complaints per 100 orders, refund rate, support response time.

The single most important number: orders per shop per week. If shops see real customers from Mintadeal, they stay, post more deals, and later pay for boosts.

15 Risks, mitigations and open decisions

RISK	MITIGATION
Shops stop posting; deals go stale	Make posting effortless; staff help in early areas; expire old deals automatically; weekly reminders and simple results reports.
Shops slow to accept orders	WhatsApp/SMS alerts, acceptance time limit with auto-cancel and refund, ranking based on reliability.
Price or stock mismatch	Rejection with reason, stock toggles, price saved at order time, ratings.
Too few shops or customers in an area	Launch area by area; do not open a new area until the current one is working.
Strong competitors in grocery and food	Lead with categories big apps neglect (showrooms, hardware, clothing, services, venue offers); use grocery and meat for familiarity, not discount wars.
Own catalogue upsets local shops	Avoid categories local shops cover; label Mintadeal deals clearly; same rules as other vendors.
Unpaid commission and delivery dues	Deduct from prepaid payouts; prepaid delivery balance; limit on dues before pausing partner delivery.
Fake or reused QR codes	Random server-checked references, single use, vendor-only scanning, validity dates.
Delivery failures	Clear delivery areas and timings, one reliable partner, partner liability in contract, customer updates.
Tax or regulatory mismatch	Professional advice before launch; review whenever the model changes.

Decisions agreed in this version

- Customers order and pay on Mintadeal; venue offers are verified with a single-use QR scanned by the vendor.
- Deals in Bangalore shows only city-wide delivery listings and offers that need no delivery.
- Revenue switches on in stages: commission and own catalogue first, paid boosts next, onboarding fee later.
- Shops deliver themselves or ask Mintadeal to book a partner; Mintadeal pays the partner and recovers the cost from the shop.

Still to decide

- First launch area and the target number and mix of shops.
- Commission rate(s) by category, payout schedule, and acceptance time limits.
- Payment provider, delivery partner and messaging provider.
- Refund rules for unused venue offers; return rules by category.
- Which own-catalogue categories to start with.

Launch gate: take paid orders only when shop verification, listing terms, order acceptance, fulfilment responsibility, payment reconciliation, support, refunds and payouts each have a named owner.

Mintadeal | Local stores. Local deals. Local customers.